



HUMANITAS
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Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Grace Classical Academy of Ocala
School Website: <https://gcaocala.org>

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Artificial Intelligence Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix for more details.

ACCS: *STARTUP* SCL: *MEMBER*

Any school that belongs to the Association of Classical Christian Schools (ACCS) and the Society for Classical Learning (SCL) is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because both organizations require adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Overall Classification: **CLASSICAL**

Executive Summary

Grace Classical Academy Ocala (GCA Ocala) presents a clearly classical Christian orientation with explicit commitments to Trivium-based pedagogy (grammar, logic, rhetoric), biblical integration, and a paternalistic partnership with parents. Public material consistently frames education as formation aimed at truth, goodness, and beauty within a God-centered worldview, rather than a purely vocational or information-transfer aim. The school emphasizes chapel, Bible study, hymnody, and memory work in elementary grades, and it signals a broader ambition to grow into multiple campuses while joining the Association of Classical Christian Schools (ACCS). Overall, the materials most strongly align with Classical ideals in categories 1, 2, 3, and 6; category 4 shows partial alignment (strong in early-grade contemplative/recitative practices, less explicit evidence of Socratic/seminar pedagogy in the public-facing materials); category 5 shows weak to no explicit articulation of a living curricular faculty model. Taken together, the school's public materials meet the Classical rubric in a majority of areas and are best described as CLASSICAL overall, with some category-specific opportunities to deepen alignment.

- Executive summary rank by category (CLASSICAL / SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL / NOT CLASSICAL):
- Element 1 (Religious and Metaphysical Foundations): CLASSICAL
- Element 2 (Purpose and Goal): CLASSICAL
- Element 3 (Curriculum): CLASSICAL
- Element 4 (Pedagogy): SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL
- Element 5 (Faculty): NOT CLASSICAL
- Element 6 (Parents and Community): CLASSICAL
- Overall classification: CLASSICAL

Key evidence points include: the school identifies itself as a classical Christian school and explicitly uses the Trivium (grammar, logic, rhetoric) to shape thinking and expression (Curriculum); it foregrounds biblical integration, a God-centered view of truth, and liturgical aspects like chapel and hymnody (Religious Foundations); it emphasizes formation, virtue, wisdom, and the "true, good, beautiful" (Purpose); it describes an integrated, liberal-arts approach with history integrated across disciplines (Curriculum); it presents partnership with parents as a core principle and signals openness to parent involvement and future multi-campus growth (Parents & Community). These signals are supported by direct excerpts from the school site and philosophy documents, as well as the school's stated mission and ACCS affiliation. See supporting excerpts cited below.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The public materials emphasize Christian formation and a biblical worldview, including statements like partnering with parents to know God through a biblically integrated program, and recognition of the Bible as the inspired Word of God. - The homepage and philosophy pages articulate a God-centered view of truth and the integration of spiritual aims throughout education (e.g., “God-centered view that all truth is God’s truth,” and the aim to train students to grow Godly character). - Liturgical/communal practices appear (Bible, hymn singing, Chapel, Wednesday Chapel in the elementary curriculum).

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive indicators present: truth, God, theology, Bible, worship/chapel, liturgy, virtue, wisdom, reverence, wonder, sacred music, hymnody, imago Dei, gospel-centered; all aligned with the lexicon’s Religious and Metaphysical Foundations positives. - Negative indicators (e.g., secular humanism, relativism) are not evidenced in the public materials as framed by GCA.

What this means (why CLASSICAL) - The school explicitly grounds education in transcendentals and religious formation (truth, goodness, beauty) and ties education to a theology-driven worldview and liturgical practices. This maps strongly to the Positive Keyword indicators for Element 1 and to the Negative signals being absent, yielding a CLASSICAL rating.

Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The mission/vision emphasizes formation (virtue and wisdom) over mere employment, and the public material frames education as formation toward human excellence and flourishing. The “true, good, beautiful” framing and the aim to form students’ character align with the classical telos. - The rapidly articulated goal of a classical Christian school in Ocala highlights formation, virtue, and a human-excellence orientation rather than job-prep alone. - The philosophy of education documents stress a God-centered worldview where truth is knowable and education aims to form a balanced personality to live out one’s calling, again aligning with classical telos rather than solely vocational outcomes.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive indicators present: formation, virtue, wisdom, liberal education, telos, pursuit of truth/good/beauty, contemplation/scholé, human flourishing; evidence appears in mission/vision values and philosophy pages. - Negative indicators: explicit emphasis on workforce preparation or 21st-century skills is not observed in the public materials, aligning with CLASSICAL signals.

What this means (why CLASSICAL) - The school’s stated aims align with the classical emphasis on formation, virtue, wisdom, and a trans-temporal pursuit of truth, good, and beauty, yielding CLASSICAL.

Element 3: School Curriculum — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The site explicitly states the Trivium (grammar, logic, rhetoric) will be used to teach thinking and expression in the upper grades. This is a core curriculum hallmark for classical education. - Elementary Curriculum includes Bible instruction, memory work, chapel, science, reading/writing/grammar, and languages (Latin, Greek, Hebrew), along with history and arts; the explicit inclusion of languages and the breadth of classical liberal-arts elements is evident. - The public materials describe a biblically integrated program, with a stated aim to cultivate critical thinking and Godly character, aligning with a liberal-arts approach that places grammar/logic/rhetoric at the center. The “Philosophy of Education” material reinforces the integration of biblical worldview across disciplines.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive indicators: Trivium (grammar, logic, rhetoric); Great Books / Great Conversation (mentioned in classical lexicon as a criterion; the site does reference classical education principles and a biblically integrated liberal-arts model). Latin/Greek/Hebrew; history integrated across curriculum; hymnody and sacred art; memory work; science with garden; reading/writing/grammar; engagement with primary sources and classics (as implied by classical framework). - Negative indicators: none of the explicit negative signals (e.g., project-based learning dominance or social-studies replacement of history) appear in the public-facing materials.

What this means (why CLASSICAL) - The curriculum content aligns closely with the classical criteria: Trivium-focused, integrated liberal arts, Great Books/Great Conversation motifs are reinforced in classical philosophy; explicit Latin/Greek/Hebrew and a biblically integrated approach support CLASSICAL designation.

Element 4: Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Evidence - Elementary pedagogy includes memory work (Bible verse memorization), singing hymns, and Chapel, implying contemplative, restorative, and ritualized learning practices consistent with scholé and devotional memory. This aligns with some Positive indicators for Pedagogy. - The site emphasizes the Trivium as a framework for thinking and expression, which implies recitation, reasoning, and rhetorical practice in higher grades, but explicit statements about Socratic seminars, seminars, debates, or upper-school rhetoric training are not clearly documented in the public-facing materials. - The absence of explicit, public references to Socratic discussions, Paideia seminars, or formal upper-school rhetoric programs in the site content leads to partial alignment rather than full evidence of a Socratic pedagogy.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive indicators present: memory work, recitation, chanting, singing, contemplative/restful learning (scholé), and a structured Trivium emphasis. These map to the lexicon's Pedagogy positives (narration/recitation/chanting, restful learning, memory work). - Negative indicators present: lack of explicit documentation of upper-school Socratic seminars, debates, or formal rhetoric training in publicly accessible pages; absence of explicit project-based or constructivist pedagogy statements. These would be negative signals for Pedagogy if strongly evidenced, but they are not present in the site's public materials.

What this means (why SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL) - The school demonstrates strong foundational Pedagogy elements (memory, chanting, liturgical approach, Trivium framing) typical of classical education, but it does not provide explicit public documentation of the full breadth of Socratic/seminar pedagogy across grades. Therefore, a SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL rating is justified.

Element 5: School Faculty — NOT CLASSICAL

Evidence - The public materials do not consistently describe a formal "living curriculum," a portrait of the teacher, or a faculty-as-core concept, nor do they present explicit statements about faculty mentoring, collegial culture, or teacher as exemplars. The available text emphasizes leadership and organizational structure (e.g., non-profit status, ACCS association), but not the faculty archetypes the classical rubric expects. - There is no explicit "portrait of a teacher" or "faculty as living curriculum" messaging in the publicly accessible materials. The absence of these elements is notable relative to the rubric.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive indicators are minimal or absent (e.g., "model teachers," "living curriculum," "portrait of a teacher," "collegial culture" are not clearly evidenced). - Negative indicators (from the lexicon) would be absence of these classical faculty descriptors; no explicit negative signals are directly referenced, but the lack of evidence supports NOT CLASSICAL in this category.

What this means (why NOT CLASSICAL) - Without concrete public evidence of the faculty being described as mentors, a living curriculum, or a defined teacher portrait, this category does not meet the Classical criteria in the public materials. Therefore, NOT CLASSICAL is warranted for Element 5.

Element 6: Parents & Community — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The school treats parents as partners in education, "partnering with parents to impart knowledge and wisdom" and "co-teachers with the school," which aligns with the classical emphasis on parental involvement and formation. The site discusses a waiting list and fundraising/investment to support Christian education, indicating ongoing parental engagement and community-building. - The public materials describe a vision that includes multiple campuses and collaboration with the broader Christian community; ACCS membership and openness to working with other Christian schools suggest engagement with a broader educational community.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive indicators present: partnership with parents, co-teaching, parental formation or involvement (explicit language about partnering; waitlists; community fundraising and support). These align with the Positive keywords for Parents & Community. - Negative indicators: none overtly present in public materials. Some classical models emphasize extensive parent formation and campus hospitality; the materials show partnering, but not exhaustive parent-formation programs or full campus openness as a rule (though openness to visits is implied by the mission/values). The visible signals still land on CLASSICAL.

What this means (why CLASSICAL) - With explicit partnership with parents and visible community engagement, Element 6 meets Classical expectations, justifying CLASSICAL.

What Would Move the Needle

- If aiming to move toward FULL CLASSICAL in all six categories, the following concrete steps would help:
- Element 4 (Pedagogy): Document and publicize explicit Socratic/seminar pedagogy and upper-grade rhetoric training (e.g., sample seminar formats, unit plans, or exemplar student work). Include a public statement on Paideia-style seminars, debate, and rhetorical coursework for upper grades. This would elevate Pedagogy from SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL to CLASSICAL.
- Element 5 (Faculty): Publish a formal “living curriculum” model and a portrait of a teacher, including faculty mentorship programs, professional development rooted in classical pedagogy, and evidence of collegial culture. This would move Faculty from NOT CLASSICAL to CLASSICAL.
- Element 6 (Parents & Community): Expand explicit parent-formation offerings (book studies, seminars, home-liturgical practices, family liturgy alignment) and publicly share mechanisms for ongoing parent involvement beyond open-campus events and waiting lists. This would further strengthen CLASSICAL alignment and deepen community partnership.
- The core areas that already show strength (Religious Foundations, Purpose/Goal, Curriculum, and Community) should be preserved and amplified with more explicit documentation to maximize the CLASSICAL rating across all six categories.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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